



Passaic County Community College
Academic Year: 2024-2025
Standard Syllabus

Department Chair: Petar Drakulich
Program Coordinator: Lonna Murphy

Course Code: PS 305

Course Title: Introduction to Cognitive Psychology

Department: Social Sciences

Semesters Offered: Spring

Course Description: This course will provide an overview of the theories and methods used in the study of human cognitive processes. Some of the topics covered will be perception, attention, memory, and problem solving.

Prerequisites: PS 101

Credits: 4

Lecture Hours: 4

Lab/Studio Hours: 0

Clinical/Fieldwork Hours: 0

Required Textbook/Materials: Goldstein, B. *Cognitive Psychology: Connecting Mind Research and Everyday Experience*. Wadsworth Cengage Learning

Additional Time and Supplemental Requirements: Based on a 15 week semester, students are expected to complete approximately 6 hours per week of assigned work outside of class.

Course Learning Outcomes: Upon completion of this course, students will be able to:

1. Describe the historical development of cognitive psychology.
2. Explain why memory is unreliable.
3. Compare classic research to modern research (within the last 10 years).
4. Apply research on Long Term Memory to studying for college exams.
5. Contrast memory with creativity.
6. Explain some of the broader implications of cognitive research for society.

General Education Outcomes: Not a general education course

Grading Standards:

3 exams	75%
4 experiment write-ups	25%

Course Content:

History
Cognitive Neuroscience
Perception
Attention
Short term memory and Working memory

Long term memory – structure
Long term memory – encoding, retrieval, and consolidation
Everyday memory, and memory errors
Conceptual knowledge
Visual imagery
Problem solving and creativity
Judgement, decisions, and reasoning

College Policies:

For Information regarding:

- PCCC's Academic Integrity Code
- Student Conduct Code
- Student Grade Appeal Process

Please refer to the PCCC Student Handbook and PCCC Catalog

Panther Alert:

The College will announce delayed openings, closings, and other emergency situations through the Panther Alert System. Students are encouraged to sign up for Panther Alert Notifications by logging into their student accounts through the PCCC website at www.pccc.edu and following Panther Alert System instructions.

Requesting Reasonable Accommodations at Passaic County Community College: Passaic County Community College Office of Accessibility Services, in accordance with Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) of 1990, and the Americans with Disabilities Act Amendments Act (ADAAA) of 2008 is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to students with documented disabilities. If you have a disability and believe you need accommodations, please contact the Office of Accessibility Services (OAS) at (973) 684-6395 or email ods@pccc.edu. Students should request accommodations as early as possible, since they may take time to implement.